This one-pot meal of slowly cooked vegetables flavored with pork and confit of duck comes from southwest France. It is best made the day before and reheated.

garbure

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 40 MINS **COOK** 1 HR **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

3½oz (100g) diced bacon or pancetta
1 Spanish onion, finely chopped
3 garlic cloves, crushed
1 leg confit of duck
1½ quarts (1½ liters) chicken stock
1 small Savoy cabbage, core removed and leaves cut into 1 x 3in (2.5 x 7.5cm) strips
1 large carrot, sliced
1 celery rib, diced
1 leek, cleaned and sliced
1 large floury potato, cubed
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 tsp pimentón picante or hot smoked paprika
½ tsp ground cumin
2–3 sprigs of fresh thyme
2–3 sprigs of flat-leaf parsley, plus 1 tbsp finely chopped parsley to garnish
1 x 9oz (250g) can white beans, drained, rinsed, and drained again
8–12 croûtes (see p39), rubbed with garlic and brushed with olive oil, to serve

1 Put a large, deep, heavy-based soup pot over medium heat, add the bacon or pancetta, and cook, stirring frequently, for 2–3 minutes or until crisp and cooked through. Remove with a slotted spoon and drain on paper towels. Add the onion and garlic to the pot, reduce the heat a little, and cook, stirring frequently, for 5–8 minutes or until softened.

2 Pick the meat from the duck leg, discarding the skin and bones but reserving the fat, and cut into shreds. Stir the meat into the onion and garlic, then add the stock, cabbage, carrot, celery, leek, and potato. Season lightly with salt and more generously with freshly ground black pepper, then add the pimentón or paprika, cumin, thyme, and parsley. Bring to a simmer, cover, reduce the heat a little, and cook, stirring occasionally, for 30 minutes.

3 Lift out the thyme and parsley. Lightly mash the beans in a bowl, then stir them into the soup and continue cooking until the vegetables are tender. Taste and adjust the seasoning. To serve, stir in the reserved bacon or pancetta along with 1 tbsp of the duck fat, then sprinkle with the parsley. Place a croûte in each bowl and ladle the piping hot soup on top.